

the world will benefit greatly from this metaverse in terms of remote work, networking, collaboration, collecting, and preserving evidence from crime scenes, and training in specific skills like forensic investigation. However, skilling up is not the only motive behind launching the metaverse. INTERPOL also wants law enforcers to better understand metaverse dynamics so they can prevent or address crimes therein.

The INTERPOL also announced the creation of an expert group on the metaverse, “to represent the concerns of law enforcement on the global stage—ensuring this new virtual world is secure by design.”

According to a Gartner report, by 2026, one in every four people will spend at least an hour a day in the metaverse to work, study, shop, and socialise. On the other hand, the newly released INTERPOL Global Crime Trend report shows that crime has increasingly moved online. The World Economic Forum has also warned of social engineering scams, violent extremism, and misinformation on the metaverse.

As the metaverse grows, we are likely to see crimes against children, data theft, money launder-

ing, financial fraud, counterfeiting, ransomware, phishing, and sexual assault and harassment. These will present significant challenges for law enforcement. Hence, this pre-emptive step by INTERPOL to experience and understand the metaverse is extremely noteworthy.

“By identifying these risks from the outset, we can work with stakeholders to shape the necessary governance frameworks and cut off future criminal markets before they are fully formed,” says Madan Oberoi, INTERPOL’s Executive Director of Technology and Innovation. “Only by having these conversations now can we build an effective response.”

Diwali pujas and wellness gyaan

This Diwali, Totality Corp organised Lakshmi Puja on the Zionverse, its metaverse that is based on Indian culture and mythology! Zionverse offered users a choice of private or public rooms to experience the puja. Users could invite their family and friends to



Teams can meet and collaborate in NVIDIA Omniverse’s real-time, photorealistic virtual environment (Courtesy: NVIDIA)

their private room through a QR code. In the public room, users celebrated with the rest of the community.

Speaking of spirituality and well-being, personal transformation coach Deepak Chopra announced the launch of the ChopraVerse, a collaboration between Seva.Love—a metaverse for wellbeing initiative, and Utopia—an emerging Web3 ecosystem. Deepak Chopra’s home in the metaverse, The House of Enlightenment, has been designed by Vera Iconica Architecture.

As part of the initial launch, users can experience the house on the metaverse and purchase downloadable blueprints as NFTs. This is something interesting, because the design, which incorporates elements of eastern wisdom and design principles for wellness, can be replicated in the physical world using these blueprints. ChopraVerse will also feature gamified content for kids, to play and learn the secrets of wellness early in life. Checkout <https://www.chopraverse.io>.

Speaking to CoinDesk TV’s *First Mover* in October, Deepak Chopra remarked that tech giants need better motivation for moving into the metaverse than just making money, if they want to make a true impact and avoid the fate of the dinosaurs!

AR, meta, mobiles, who will win the race?

Despite so many people trying to set foot in the metaverse, many global

More nuggets of meta news

- Adobe has added a new set of tools to its Substance 3D suite of creator tools, for users to create metaverse-ready immersive experiences. The company has signed a partnership with Meta to make Substance 3D available to users of the Quest VR platform, so they can build their own 3D content. According to Adobe, Substance 3D is already used by companies like Microsoft, Ubisoft, Epic Games, and NVIDIA to prototype and deploy early metaverse experiences.
- Ghaziabad based AnyTech Ventures has developed AnyTech Meta, a tech expo that is available 24×7, 365 days in the metaverse. According to the company, participants can look around virtual stores showcasing computer hardware, software, and other products from global manufacturers. They can get their questions answered through real-time, two-way audio conversations with company representatives and other users. This gives companies an opportunity to directly engage with the user community from across the world. AnyTech gives the exhibitors a number of options for integrating call-to-action (CTA) and point-of-sale (POS) systems into their metaverse spaces, allowing for extensive personalisation.
- Meta and Microsoft recently announced a partnership to enable the use of Mesh for Microsoft Teams, Windows 365, and Microsoft 365 apps like Excel, Outlook, and PowerPoint on Meta Quest virtual reality devices. This will make remote collaboration an exciting experience.
- The world is facing a real energy crisis. There is a shortage, and hence a rise in the price of oil, gas, and electricity. Miners have been taking flak from energy campaigners, since traditional proof-of-work (PoW) blockchains are very energy intensive. Moreover, increase in energy prices also raises the costs for miners, which could eventually force them to sell their Bitcoins, thereby pushing down prices. Experts feel this is the right time for miners to move to sustainable platforms like Ethereum 2.0, which relies on a far more energy-efficient proof-of-stake (PoS) mechanism.